



Did you know...

Twin pregnancies can bring additional nausea and vomiting. While it doesn't happen for every expectant mom of twins, there is an increased risk of nausea and vomiting due to the higher hCG levels (see p.39) in a twin, or other multiple, pregnancy. There are also higher levels of the hormone progesterone with twins, which can cause shortness of breath. In later pregnancy, carrying multiple babies can lead to more fatigue, constipation, heartburn, and back pain for mom-to-be.

Q I'm pregnant but I have no symptoms. Should I be worried?

It's normal for some women to experience few or no symptoms in early pregnancy, even though hormones are flooding the body and changes are underway. This is nothing to worry about—you are just as pregnant as a woman who has nausea and vomiting, for example, but just not as sensitive to the hormonal changes that are taking place.

Even though you may not feel the fatigue associated with early pregnancy, be sure to get rest and take good care of yourself.

Q Are there any pregnancy symptoms I should be concerned about?

Although concerning symptoms are not common in early pregnancy, seek medical advice if you have any of the following symptoms.

- » **Vaginal bleeding:** light spotting is common but you must report it to your doctor. Heavy bleeding, especially if you also have abdominal cramps, can be a sign of a threatening miscarriage. Bleeding and lower abdominal pain can also signal an ectopic pregnancy (see p.308).
- » **Severe vomiting:** seek advice if you are vomiting to the point of dehydration and can't keep any fluids down for more than 12 hours.
- » **A fever:** you may have an infection.
- » **Vaginal discharge and itching:** this may mean you have an infection such as yeast. It can be treated to offer relief from the symptoms.

Q I'm five weeks pregnant. I feel OK, but what symptoms might I get?

Most women experience some symptoms in early pregnancy due to the hormonal changes taking place. Thankfully many of these pass, especially morning sickness, by the end of the first trimester or early in the second trimester.

EARLY PREGNANCY SYMPTOMS

All women are different, but here are some of the symptoms you may experience in early pregnancy.



The most reliable sign of pregnancy is a **missed period**. If your period is late, do a pregnancy test.

- » **A burning sensation when you urinate:** this can be the sign of urinary-tract infection, which will need to be treated with antibiotics.
- » **Leg or calf pain, swelling on one side, and/or a severe headache:** these are signs of a blood clot, which is more likely to occur in pregnancy, though it is rare.
- » **A flare-up of a current medical condition:** let your doctor know of any symptoms that you have experienced since being pregnant.

7 in 10

women experience nausea or vomiting or both during pregnancy.